Aga Khan University Examination Board

Notes from E-Marking Centre HSSC-II English Compulsory Examination May 2018

Introduction:

This document has been produced for the teachers and candidates of Higher Secondary School Certificate (HSSC) Part II course of English Compulsory. It contains comments on candidate responses to the 2018 HSSC examination, indicating the quality of the responses and highlighting their relative strengths and weaknesses.

E-Marking Notes:

This includes overall comments on candidates' performance on every question and *some* specific examples of candidates' responses which support the mentioned comments. Please note that the descriptive comments represent an overall perception of the better and weaker responses as gathered from the e-marking session. However, the candidates' responses shared (where deemed necessary) in this document represent some specific example(s) of the mentioned comments.

The following is a description of the tasks and skills required for fulfilment of those tasks.

Question No	Question Type	Skills Assessed
1 (a,b,c,d)	CRQs on a reading passage	- Ability to understand a reading text on a literal level (main/ sub ideas) - Ability to understand a reading text on inferential level (opinions, evidence, reasoning, cause and effect, reading between the lines)
2	Cloze Passage	- Ability to read and understand the given text - Ability to provide missing information as per the context of a passage
3 and 4 (a,b,c)	Letter and Essay Writing	- Ability to develop a formal piece of writing with appropriate focus, organisation and purpose - Ability to persuade, argue, reflect and analyse familiar topics/ situations - Ability to use accurate sentence structure, connective devices, spellings, etc.

Teachers and candidates should be aware that examiners may ask questions that address the Student Learning Outcomes (SLOs) in a manner that requires candidates to respond by integrating knowledge, understanding and application skills they have developed by studying the course.

Candidates also need to know that the marks allocated to the question and the answer space (which is provided on the examination paper), are a guide to the length of the required response. A longer response will not in itself lead to higher marks. Writing far beyond the indicated space may reduce the time available for answering other questions.

Candidates need to be familiar with the command words which contain some terms commonly used in examination questions. However, candidates should also be aware that not all questions will start with, or contain, a word from AKU-EB's command word list. Questions such as 'how?', 'why?' or 'what?' may also be asked.

Note: Student responses reproduced in this report have not been corrected for grammar, spelling or factual information.

Detailed Comments:

Question 1

Question 1 was based on a reading passage. It had four sub-parts. Candidates were required to understand the reading passage and accordingly answer the questions asked on various aspects of the passage. The reading passage was an article, *The Science Behind Why We Love Ice Cream* by Shirley S. Wang. The article highlighted the importance of developing and detecting taste at an earlier age and the genetic predisposition that complements to our likes and dislikes for certain food groups.

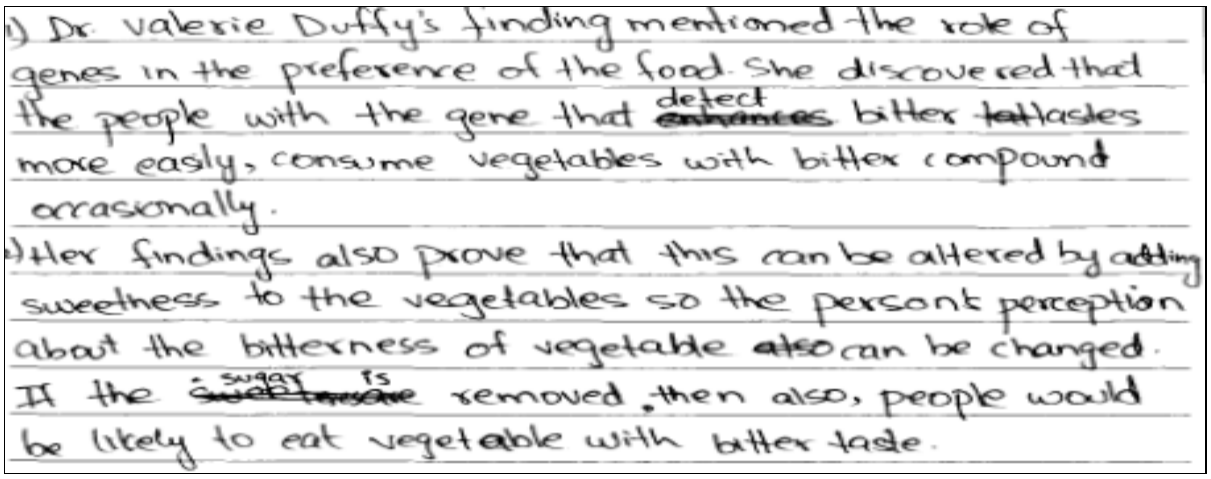
Question 1a:

a. Summarise Dr Valerie Duffy's findings mentioned in the last two paragraphs of the passage in no more than TWO sentences.

The question aimed to assess candidates' skill to summarise the main idea.

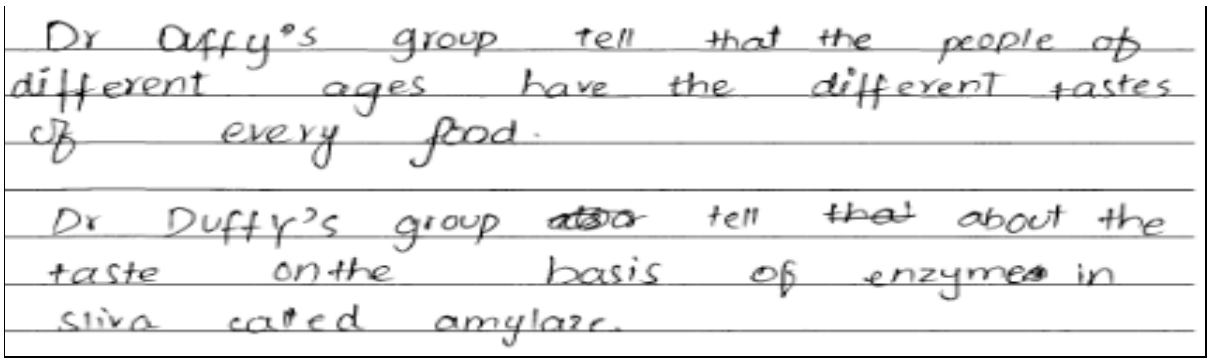
In *better responses* candidates identified all main ideas correctly and used concise language to reiterate those main ideas in two sentences. Mostly, the answers included the following points: 'People have a genetic predisposition/ ability to detect textures and tastes. However, this preference can be changed by exposing the individual to the taste at a young age or by masking the bitterness.' Conciseness of language and brevity of thought were the main features of better responses.

Example:


i) Dr. Valerie Duffy's finding mentioned the role of genes in the preference of the food. She discovered that the people with the gene that detect bitter tastes more easly, consume vegetables with bitter compound occasionally.
ii) Her findings also prove that this can be altered by adding sweetness to the vegetables so the person's perception about the bitterness of vegetable also can be changed. If the sugar is removed, then also, people would be likely to eat vegetable with bitter taste.

In *weaker responses* candidates mentioned unnecessary details and were not able to mention main ideas. The candidates failed to understand the passage and the crux of the findings by the doctor in the said text. Most answers centred on Dr Duffy's group rather than the outcome of their research as demanded by the question.

Example:


Dr Duffy's group tell that the people of different ages have the different tastes of every food.

Dr Duffy's group tell that about the taste on the basis of enzymes in saliva called amylase.

Question 1b:

Ali is 5 years old and he hates the taste of peas. Whenever his mother gives him peas for lunch, he gives them to his friend Sarah who likes them.

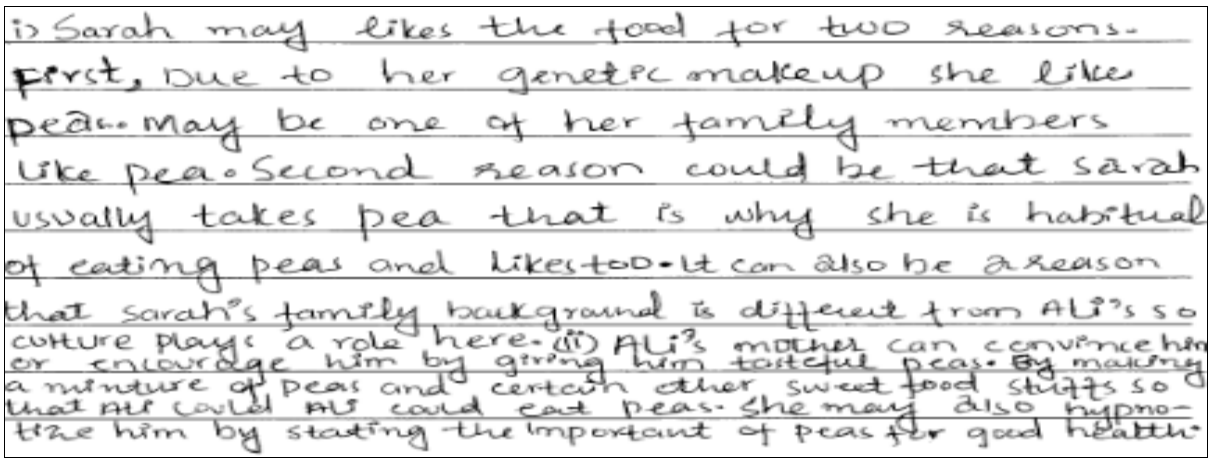
i. With reference to the text, suggest any TWO possible reasons why Sarah likes peas but Ali does not.

ii. With reference to the text, suggest ONE way in which Ali's mother can encourage him to eat his peas.

The question attempted to assess the skill of close-reading and tracking of textual details.

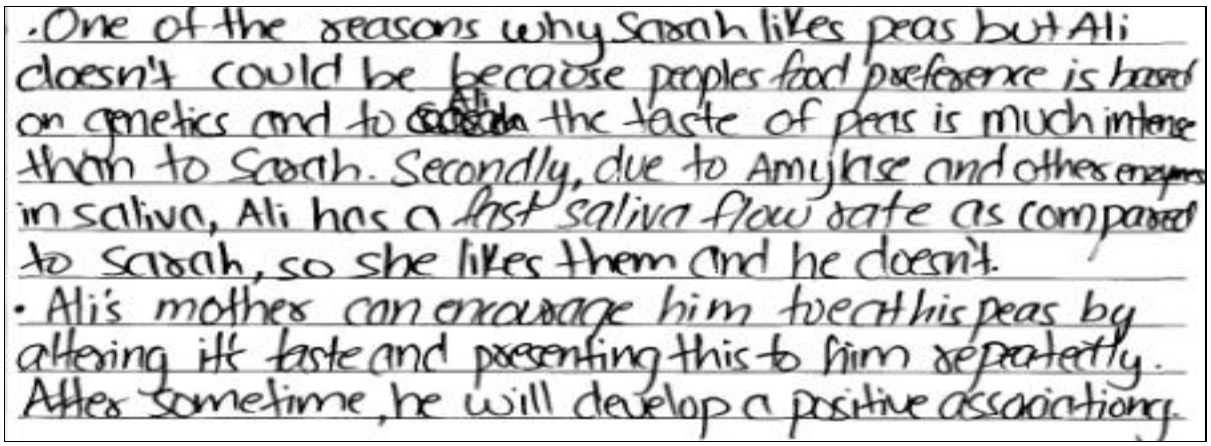
In most of the *better responses*, candidates mentioned any two reasons why Sarah likes peas but Ali does not. Mostly the responses included: 'the amount of amylase present in his saliva may be making the peas feel too slimy', 'he is genetically prone to sensing intense bitterness.' In the second part of the text, plausible suggestion like 'sweetening the peas' or 'changing recipe' were mentioned.

Example:


i> Sarah may likes the food for two reasons. First, Due to her genetic makeup she like pea. May be one of her family members like pea. Second reason could be that sarah usually takes pea that is why she is habitual of eating peas and likes too. It can also be a reason that sarah's family background is different from Ali's so culture plays a role here. (ii) Ali's mother can convince him or encourage him by giving him tasteful peas. By making a mixture of peas and certain other sweet food stuffs so that Ali could Ali could eat peas. She may also hypnotize him by stating the important of peas for good health.

Weaker responses displayed confusion as candidates mentioned reasons like 'cultural unfamiliarity' which do not match the context provided in the question. In the second part, candidates who scored less mentioned unconvincing suggestions like 'mother should explain the benefits of eating healthy'.

Example:


• One of the reasons why Sarah likes peas but Ali doesn't could be because peoples food preference is based on genetics and to Ali the taste of peas is much intense than to Sarah. Secondly, due to Amylase and other enzyms in saliva, Ali has a fast saliva flow rate as compared to Sarah, so she likes them and he doesn't.
• Ali's mother can encourage him to eat his peas by altering its taste and presenting this to him repeatedly. After sometime, he will develop a positive associations.

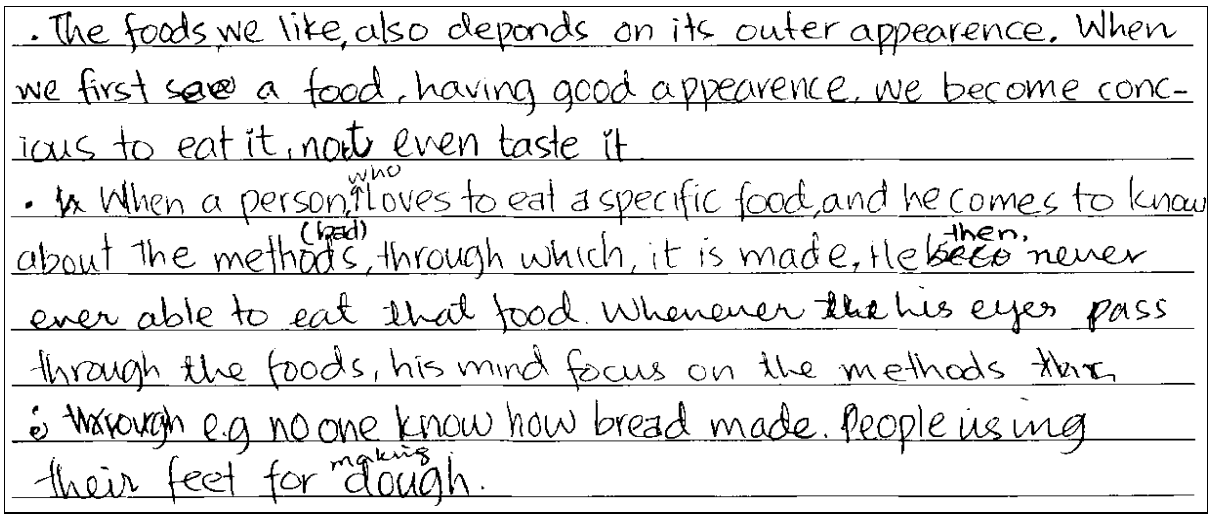
Question 1c:

Imagine yourself as the co-author of this article. Add any TWO details to the passage.

The question aimed to assess the overall comprehension. It required students to assume the role of the author, understand the author's message and tone and then reproduce it with new content which fits well with the passage. The question discriminated well between those who understood the author's perspective and could think and create content on similar lines and those who struggled with it.

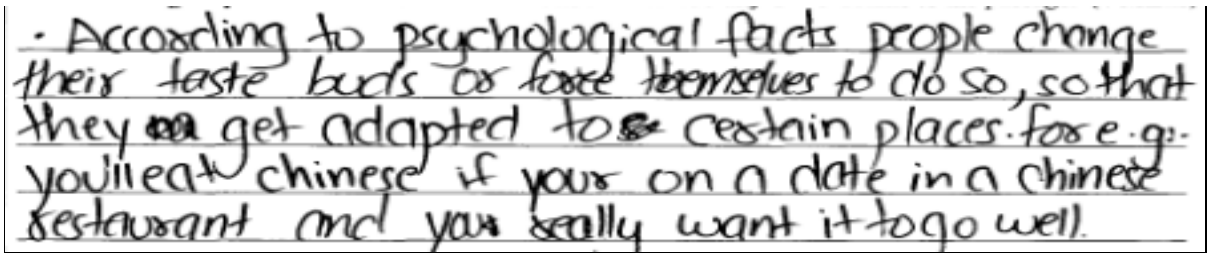
In *better responses*, candidates displayed freshness of insight, and plausible/ logical thinking. Relevant ideas and details were added to the passage displaying clarity of expression. For example, 'appearance and/ or smell of food also plays an important part in increasing or decreasing its appeal.'

Example:



In *weaker responses*, most candidates followed a superficial approach. At times, there were generalised comments, rewording of the passage, or mention of relevant ideas but with no added value.

Example:



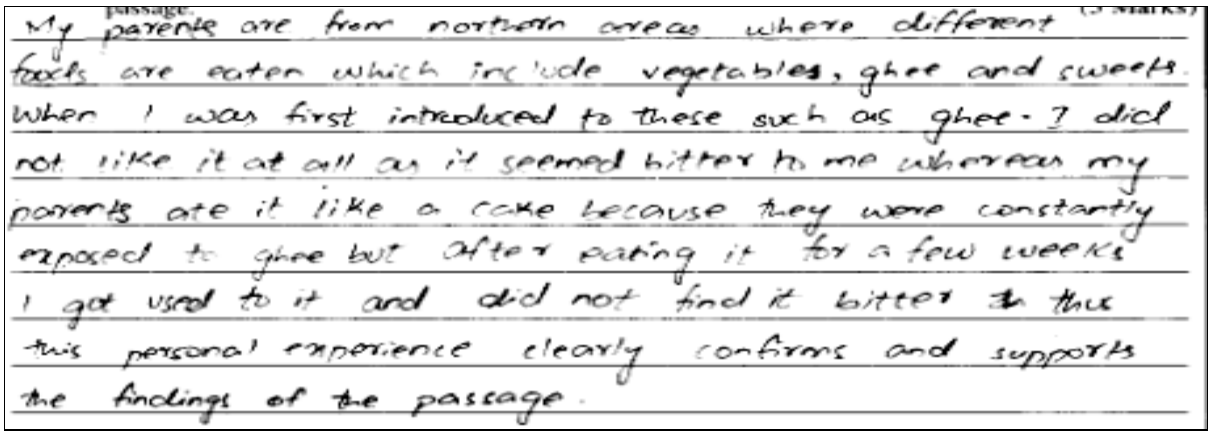
Question 1d:

Relate a personal experience about food preferences to confirm or deny the findings of this passage.

The question was generally well-attempted.

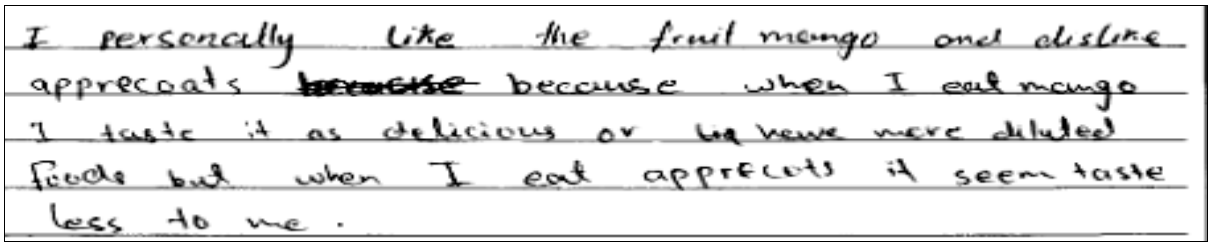
In *better responses*, candidates mentioned plausible incidents/ experiences regarding their food habits in the past and how by repeated trying/ by adding different flavours/ naturally with passage of time they started liking that food. The language used was precise and candidates were conscious of coherence and relevance.

Example:


My parents are from northern areas where different passage foods are eaten which include vegetables, ghee and sweets. When I was first introduced to these such as ghee. I did not like it at all as it seemed bitter to me whereas my parents ate it like a cake because they were constantly exposed to ghee but after eating it for a few weeks I got used to it and did not find it bitter in this this personal experience clearly confirms and supports the findings of the passage.

In *weaker responses*, candidates mentioned irrelevant answers and were not able to focus on the main requirement of the question which is to mention an incident which has to confirm or deny author's findings about food preferences. At times, incorrect views, personal judgements, details and examples were mentioned without referring those to the findings of the passage.

Example:


I personally like the fruit mango and dislike apprecoats ~~because~~ because when I eat mango I taste it as delicious or big leaves were diluted foods but when I eat apprecots it seem taste less to me.

Question 2:

This question was a cloze passage. Candidates had to read the passage carefully and fill in the missing words with respect to the situation, grammar and context.

The cloze passage was attempted well. The requirement of the question was to gauge the central idea of the passage so that it will help in inserting appropriate words. Marking scheme was relaxed to accommodate partially correct words, misspelled words/ and at times two words. Though the overall result is satisfactory, the performance indicates a need for focus and practice.

Better responses displayed appropriate use of words with respect to situation, grammar and context in each of the given blanks. Thorough understanding of the context and meaning of the passage was reflected in better responses.

Example:

Baked or fried, boiled or roasted, as chips or fries. At some point in your life, you have probably eaten a potato. Delicious, for sure, but, the fact is, potatoes have played a much more significant role in our history than just that of the dietary staple we have come to know and love today.
There are hundreds of different breeds of potatoes, and 1 it turns out that beneath that yellow or brown or purple or red skin, they 2 have quite different chemistries.

Potato was first cultivated in South America and was 3 sent to Europe by the Spanish. Europeans simply didn't want to eat it as they considered potato dull and tasteless. So instead of consuming them, they 4 used potatoes as decorative garden plants.

More than 200 years would pass before the potato caught on as a major food source throughout Europe, though even then, it was predominantly 5 consumed by the lower classes. However, beginning around 1750, and thanks at least in part to the wide availability of inexpensive and nutritious potatoes. European peasants 6 having greater food security no longer found themselves at the mercy of the regularly occurring grain famines of the time, and so their populations steadily grew.

As a result, the British, Dutch and German Empires rose on the backs of the growing groups of farmers, labourers, and soldiers, thus lifting the West to its place of world dominion.
However, not all European countries 7 had empires. After the Irish adopted the potato, their population dramatically increased, as did their dependence on the tuber as a major food 8 source.

Aided by the influx of migrants, Europe then 9 formed a large, sustainable, and well-fed population who 10 were was capable of manning the emerging factories that would bring about our modern world via the Industrial Revolution. Hence, potato has played a significant role in the Industrial Revolution.

The *weaker responses* failed to provide appropriate words for most of the blanks. Such responses demonstrated lack of knowledge of sentence structures and parts of speech. Some candidates were inclined to supply only articles and prepositions as answers; this was unexpected and indicated low tendency to think about verbs. Such responses also showed limited understanding of the meaning and the context of the passage.

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Question 3

The candidates were directed to write a résumé and letter on any of the two choices given. In their preparation for the examination, candidates should know the mechanics of writing an effective and a comprehensive résumé/ letter related to the details of the given prompt. They should be guided to develop realistic résumés which reflects the context provided in the question.

Question 3a:

A leading newspaper is seeking interns having high school/ intermediate degree to work as Editorial Assistants.

Job Requirements

The primary duties are reading numerous news reports that arrive each week from writers around the world, and fact-checking articles. Other duties include work on social media, research and clerical duties like typing and field visits.

Skills Needed:

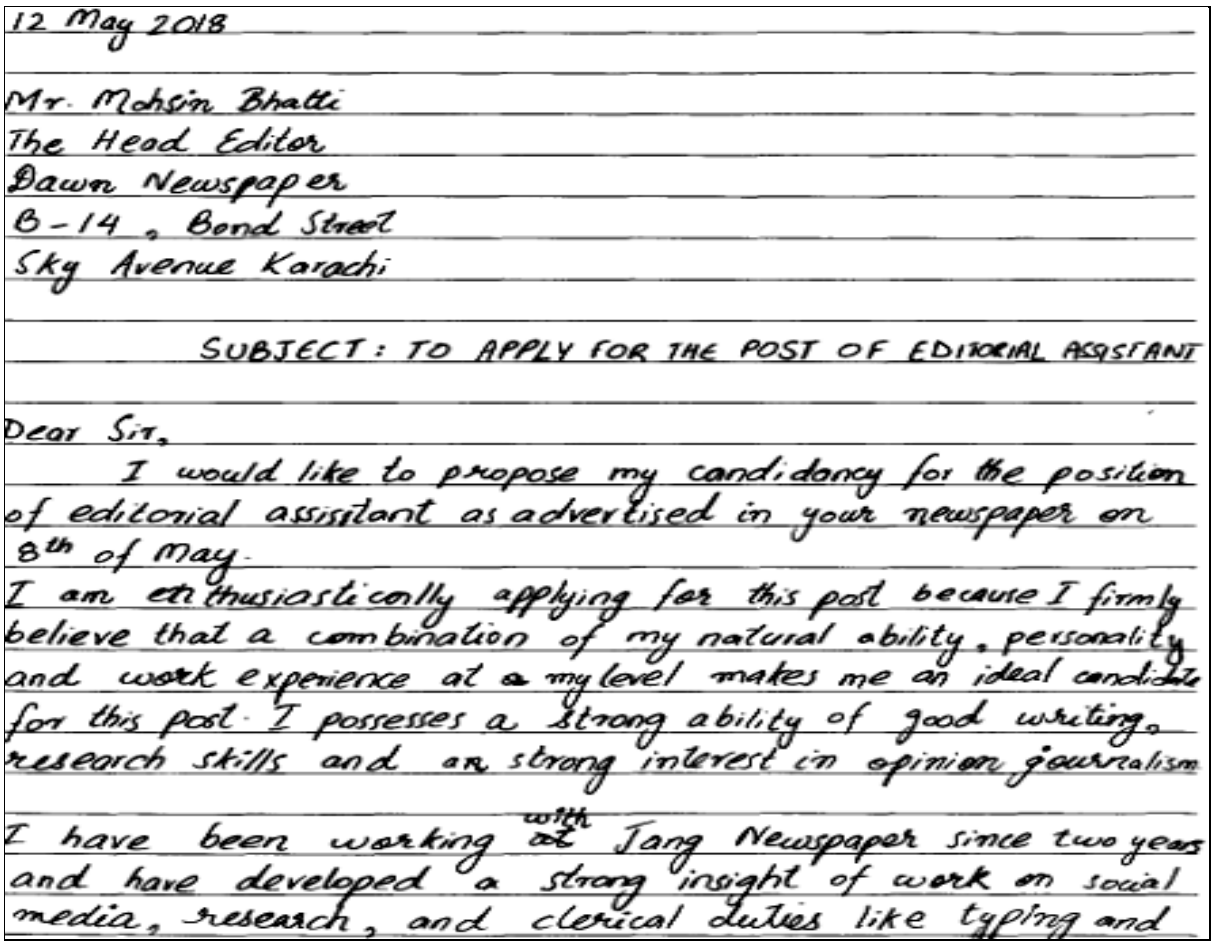
The editorial assistant must have a sharp eye for detail; a strong sense of fresh arguments and good writing; research skills; a devotion to the highest standards of accuracy, precision and verification; ability to dive into unfamiliar material on deadline; discretion in handling sensitive editorial material; and a strong interest in opinion journalism.

Compose a resume and a cover letter in response to the above given advertisement.

In *better responses* for question 3a, the candidates:

- created a résumé/ CV with complete information (personal, educational and professional), and used an appropriate format for résumé (having headings and bullets);
- wrote a covering letter mentioning reference to the advert, reasons for applying and personal/ professional summary. Required skill-set and abilities and relevant experiences were highlighted effectively;
- mentioned the educational and professional summary in descending order;
- used appropriate vocabulary to describe their suitability for the potential employment;
- showed command over language structures: grammar, punctuation, spelling, etc.

Example:



12 May 2018

Mr. Mohsin Bhatti
The Head Editor
Dawn Newspaper
B-14, Bond Street
Sky Avenue Karachi

SUBJECT: TO APPLY FOR THE POST OF EDITORIAL ASSISTANT

Dear Sir,

I would like to propose my candidancy for the position of editorial assistant as advertised in your newspaper on 8th of May.

I am enthusiastically applying for this post because I firmly believe that a combination of my natural ability, personality and work experience at a my level makes me an ideal candidate for this post. I possesses a strong ability of good writing, research skills and an strong interest in opinion journalism

I have been working with at Jang Newspaper since two years and have developed a strong insight of work on social media, research, and clerical duties like typing and

field visits. Your newspaper is well recognized all around the country and I ~~would~~ expect to definitely gain a meaningful experience

Thankyou for your time and consideration. I will be hoping for a prompt response and to discuss my further eligibility for this post with you.

Yours sincerely
ABC

A-9X4 Block 4a
Khan Street Karachi
Contact : 03XX-14XX409
email : abc125@gmail.com

ABC

Contact : 03XX-14XX409
E-mail: abc125@gmail.com

Career Objective:

To perceive a career in a reputed firm with dedicated efforts to associate myself with an association to that provides me a chance to enhance my knowledge.

Work Experience:-

Working with Jang newspaper (2016-2018)
as an assistant editor

Educational Qualifications:

HSSC from XYZ College (2016-2018)
SSC from 'PBN' School (2014-2016)

Extra-cirricular activities:

Participated in short documentary making (2015)

Skills:

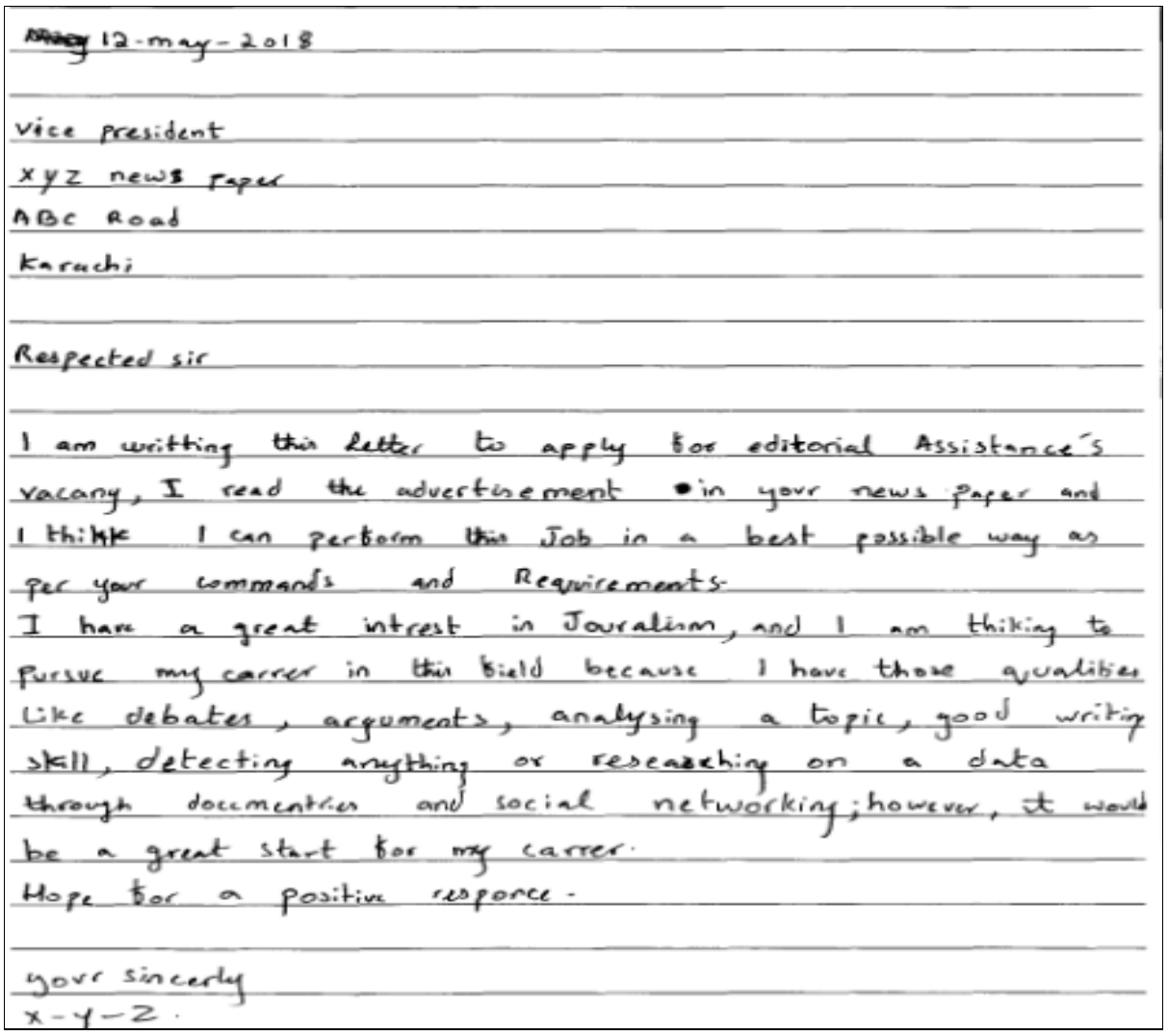
Devoted to high standards of accuracy, precision and verification
Skimming and scanning abilities

Total Word Count : 260

In *weaker responses* for question 3a, the candidates

- presented rote-learned resume; where some candidates mentioned their qualification as Masters/ Bachelors etc. They failed to address the prompt which asked for the CV of a student of intermediate;
- used informal/ internet language;
- mentioned the content in a random manner; it seemed as if planning was not done prior to writing;
- had many errors of grammar and spelling.

Example:



12-may-2018

vice president
xyz news paper
ABC Road
Karachi

Respected sir

I am writting this letter to apply for editorial Assistance's vacany, I read the advertisement in your news paper and I think I can perform this Job in a best possible way as per your commands and Requirements.
I have a great intrest in Jouralism, and I am thiking to pursue my carrer in this field because I have those qualities like debates, arguments, analysing a topic, good writing skill, detecting anything or researching on a data through documentries and social networking; however, it would be a great start for my carrer.
Hope for a positive responce.

your sincerly
x-y-z.

Resume

HUNAIN IQBAL 0392-1015156

XYZ @ Hotmail.com

Objective:-

My objective is to work and learn from such a dynamic company and give my best as an Intern. In the company's best intrest

Qualification:-

- Intermediate from XYZ Higher secondry school (2015-17)
- Matriculation from ABC school (2005-2015)

Skills:-

- Microsoft office (word, publisher, power point).
- fast typing skills
- active debater
- good reader
- explorer (documentries analysis).

Experience:-

3 months internship with smash magzine as a content writer (2017)

- 2 maths of interoship with ABC News paper as an editoreal assitant.

Hobby:-

- Declamation.
- Debates
- swimming
- reader
- Painter.

Personal skills:-

- Leadership quality.
- decision maker
- sports.

Question 3b:

Pakistan's tourism industry was at its prime during the 1970s when the country received unprecedented amounts of foreign tourists. The main destinations were the Khyber Pass, Peshawar, Karachi, Lahore, Swat, Quetta, Gwadar and Rawalpindi. Due to several reasons, tourism has significantly declined in Pakistan.

Write a report for the Tourism Authority of Pakistan. In your report, discuss:

- factors that may have affected the decrease in tourism in Pakistan.
- what should be done by the government and the citizens to attract tourists to your area.
- views of public about this issue.
- areas around you that may be developed into tourist destinations.

In *better responses* for question 3b, the candidates

- presented accurate format of a report (To/ From/ sources of information/ findings or body/ recommendation or conclusion);
- showed command over language structures: sentence structures, punctuation, spelling, etc;
- addressed the prompt adequately by highlighting the factors like terrorism, political instability, lack of facilities, etc. that have affected tourism. Suggestions for government and views of public were mentioned precisely; one or two areas that may be further developed into tourist destinations were highlighted.

Example:

Summary: This report caters about the gradual descenderse of Pakistan's tourism industry.

Introduction: This report mainly focuses on:

1. The reasons for the decrease in Tourism in Pakistan.
2. Public's opinion regarding tourism in Pakistan.
3. How to revive Pakistan's tourism industry.

Body: This report is being written to:

1. Tourism Authority of Pakistan.
2. Cheif and Prime Minister of Pakistan.

Findings:

- The reasons for the decrease in Tourism in Pakistan:

→ From the past several years the rising terrorism, political unstability in the country has potrayed Pakistan as a dangerous countrg for other people.

→ The out going protests, bomb blasts specially the incident of Army Public School, the never ending Kashmir issue, attack on Srilankan's cricket team has scared people from visiting Pakistan.

→ In Northern areas, where mostly people prefer to visit have unequal distribution of facilities. They are not provided with electricity, water and gas supply.

→ Increase in the level of pollutants and the amount of pollution has

masked the natural beauty of our country.

• Public's Opinion regarding Tourism in Pakistan:

→ In northern areas of Pakistan such as Kaghan Naran, they communicated with media regarding the unequal distribution of resources and ~~non~~ un-availability of facilities which results in less decreased number of tourists. One of the said that " For us, for the natives of northern areas, these influx of tourists is the source of income, which has now even reduced due to lack of resources provided by the government " By ABC channel.

→ In other big cities for people every such place is polluted. The guards were interviewed and they informed that people are unaware of keeping the city clean even though the dustbins are provided to them.

→ While Foreigners, donot seem comfortable and satisfied while they were invited to visit Pakistan.

Recommendations:

• How to revive tourism in Pakistan?.

→ Government and Tourist Authority to take strict actions against cleaning and maintaining of Historic places

→ Ensurance of the provision of facilities and the restorment of places.

→ ~~Introduce~~ ticket Law to be made regarding the historic places for their contamination and regarding the cultivation of forests in Pakistan.

→ Restorement of rare animals or endangered animals to be ensured.

• Areas that may develop into Tourist destinations:

Definitely Pakistan is full of such places.

→ ~~Balochistan~~ In Sindh, we can find the regims of ~~the~~ one of the oldest civilizations that is Mohenjo-Daro. Menergadh is a place located in Sindh which had regimes of Gandhara Civilization.

→ Balochistan is full of Hill stations, mesmerizing mountains and the creeks. It has Gawadar which can be develop as a Tourist destination.

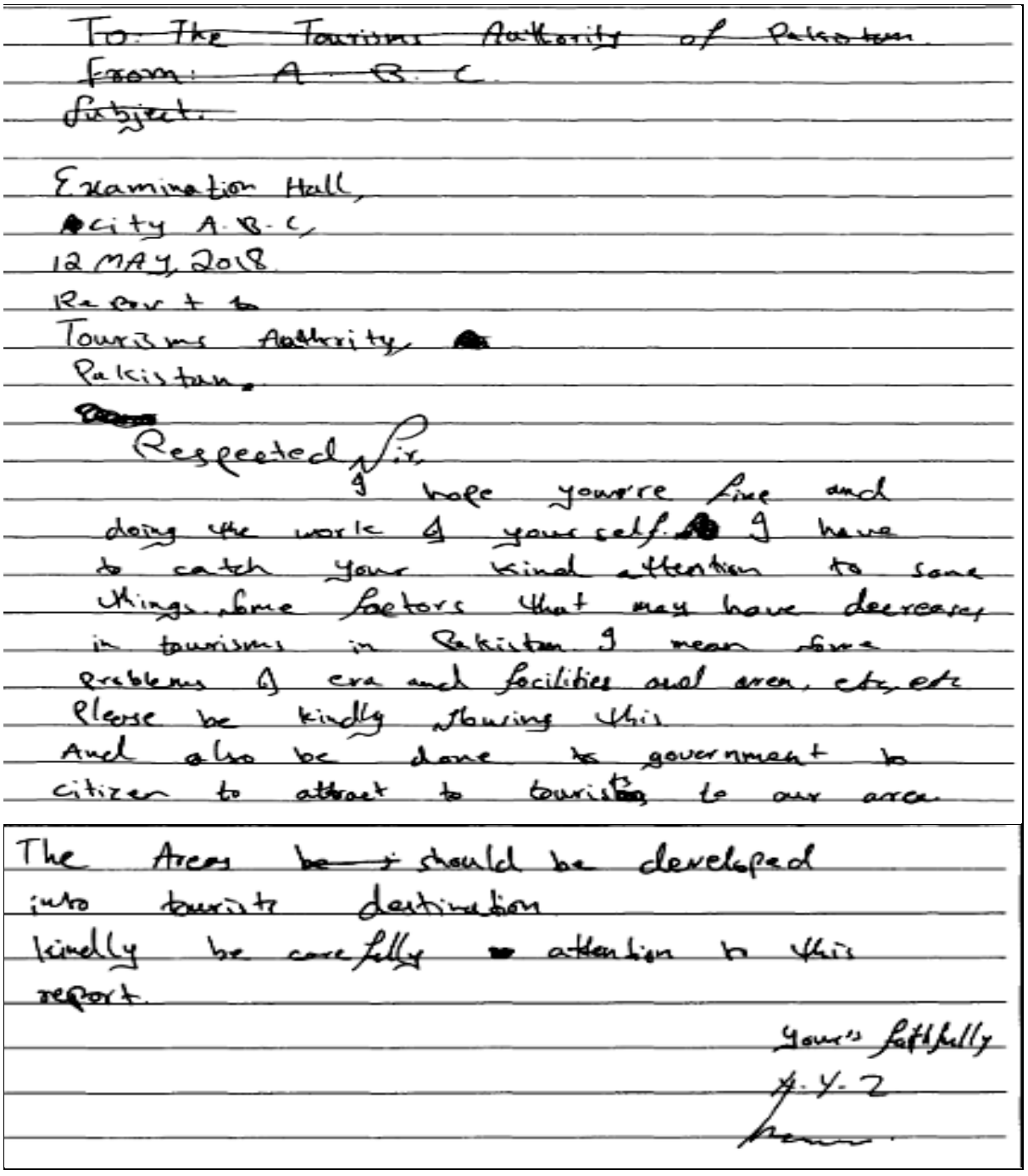
→ The Areas of Punjab and Khyber Pakhtoon Khuwa have all those perfect scenarios and destinations for tourism.

[Word count: 301]

In *weaker responses* for question 3b, the candidates

- presented many opinions and hence, digressed from the objective format of a report;
- used incorrect language structures, spellings, and grammar which made comprehension of the written response very difficult.
- used incorrect format of a report. A few students were confused between the format of a letter and report;
- confused report writing with letter writing: mostly such responses reflected lack of knowledge about the format, purpose and style of report writing;

Example:



To: The Tourism Authority of Pakistan
From: A B C
Subject:

Examination Hall,
City A.B.C,
12 MAY, 2018
Report to
Tourisms Authority,
Pakistan.

Respected Sir,
I hope you're fine and doing the work of yourself. I have to catch your kind attention to some things. Some factors that may have decreased in tourisms in Pakistan I mean some problems of era and facilities and area, etc, etc Please be kindly showing this And also be done to government to citizen to attract to tourists to our area.

The Areas be should be developed into tourists destination kindly be carefully attention to this report.

Yours faithfully
X.Y.Z

Question 4

The candidates were directed to write an essay on any of the three choices given. Most candidates chose to use the formal structure and concise and impersonal language. In their preparation for the examination, candidates should know the mechanics of writing an effective and a comprehensive essay using thesis statements and topic sentences. They should also be taught the significance of having an introduction, body and conclusion within the essay.

In the examination, the candidates need to understand what has been directed and asked in the prompt whether it is to describe or narrate, etc. In this question, the candidates were expected to show insight into the given situations to show their understanding of the situation; write on the societal and environmental issues to develop a contestable argument to validate their opinions. If paragraphs are overly long and reach to well over a page, it may well be that the line of reasoning is not as controlled as it could be in producing a response that is clear and convincing.

Question 4a:

A stereotype is any thought widely adopted about specific types of individuals or certain ways of behaving intended to represent the entire group of those individuals or behaviours as a whole. When people are categorised on some feature that they have like race, gender and religion; it is called stereotyping. One example of stereotyping is 'all Americans are overweight'.

Analyse the stereotypes that are present around you. In your essay, mention:

- whether stereotypes are positive or negative.
- examples of at least TWO stereotypes around you (Do NOT repeat the example mentioned in the question).
- whether the stereotypes mentioned by you are justified. Give reasons.

Most candidates chose to attempt this question and wrote relevant content.

In *better responses* for question 4a, the candidates:

- wrote purposeful content, used formal terms and phrases. High scoring answers were mature, sensible and had a range of interesting ideas about supporting or negating the prompt. Candidates showed understanding of stereotypes, whether they are used with positive or negative connotations, mentioned appropriate examples and gave reasoned argument;
- organised information in paragraphs by the use of specific connectors;
- used appropriate sentence structure, tenses, and subject-verb agreement;
- used simple but relevant vocabulary and correct spellings.

Example:

"Humans are social animals" and the authenticity of this phrase is proved by our own behaviour. ~~This~~ The fact, that humans cannot live in isolation and need a society for their nurture cannot be ignored and this is due to multiple reasons that we encounter ~~on~~ at daily basis. Being a human, and living in a society full of ~~positivity~~ optimism and pessimism is not easy. It indeed is a difficult task to interact with your fellow beings each having a diverse and unique mindset, thoughts and actions.

However, if we observe at our surroundings we will be able to figure out that we live in a world that is full of interactions and communications. All the agencies of socialization interlink with a person's personal and Social life. However, we all of us while interacting develop a sense of positive and negative image of people that surrounds us. This means that we start labelling people and develop stereotypes regarding them and ~~which~~ that in most of the cases is a negative label or a negative stereotype.

Labelling a group of individual on the basis of their ~~fut~~ pr past acts or ~~action~~ a negative action of one such ~~type~~ individual of that group is not a good and confirmist Social behaviour. These groups can be either be age groups or gender groups, Social groups or ethnic groups, But labelling is and stereotyping is an act that is never justified by anyone. Neither the Society nor the individuals being stereotyped. Stereotype is labelling a group of people and developing a negative

Image of ~~that~~ the group in one's mind ~~so much so~~ upto an extent where if we see any such individual belonging to the stereotyped group, our ~~we~~ mind clicks us with a negative ~~thought~~ about them.

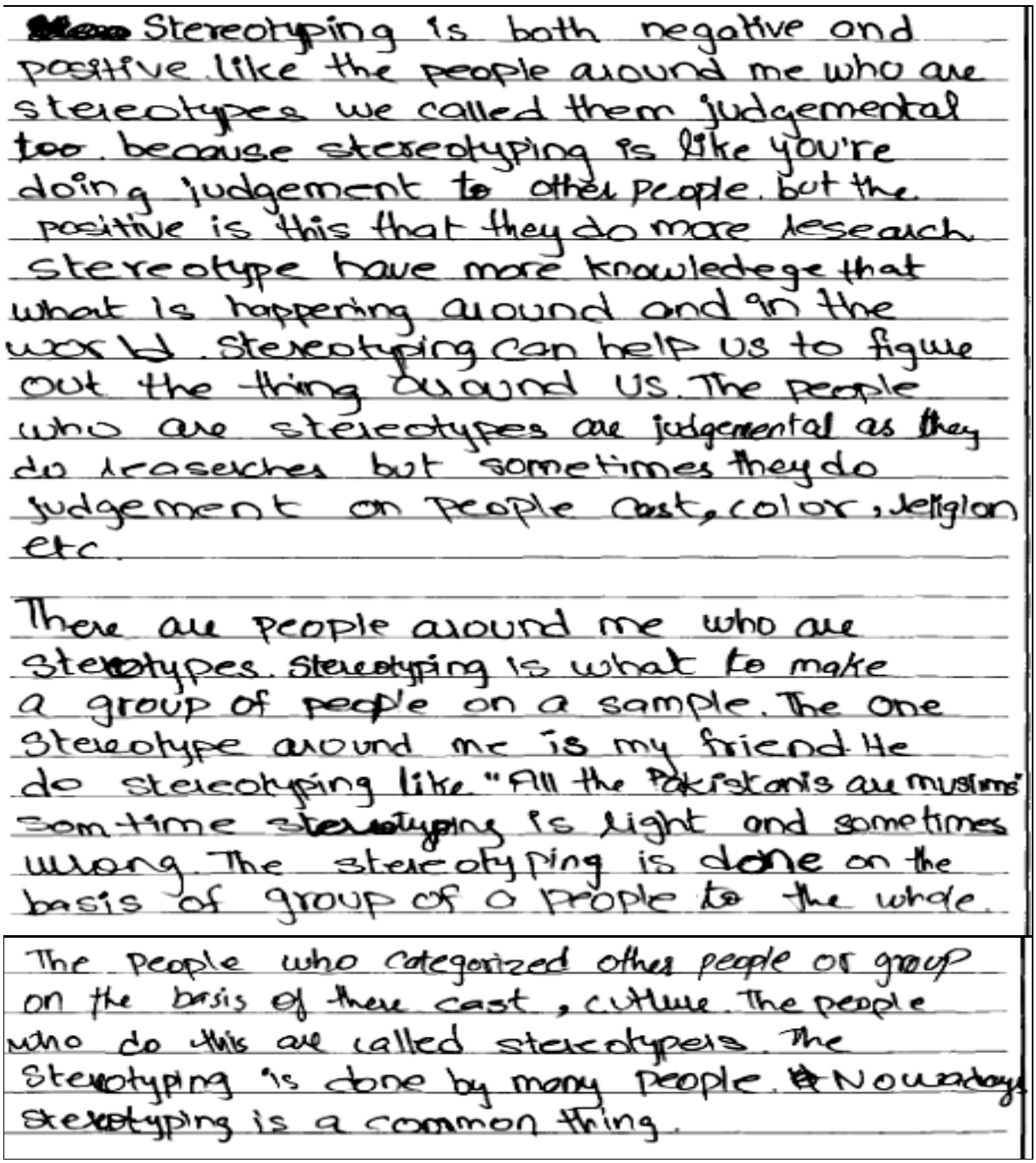
Stereotypes in today's world are just versatile. They are so much in quantity that we can even design a whole ~~su~~ new subject out of them and this is a bitter reality. Stereotype regarding the races is most commonly found in the ~~stati~~ sociological statistics ~~that~~ which suggest that most of the stereotypes found today are racial. This means stereotyping is done on the basis of skin colour. One example of such a stereotype is that " All Africans or all blacks are robbers and criminals" and this ~~is not~~ can never be true. This is because when ~~the peo~~ we look or observe the Africans we see many legends from that race. Take the example of Nelson Mandela or some really famous cricketers. ~~title~~ This clearly shows that the stereotypical view developed by the society remained limited to just few of the individuals of that race ~~tha~~ who ~~were~~ would have been involved in such ciminal activities.

Second type of stereotypes are gender biased. When looking at a woman being employed or designated at a high post in the workplace, first thought that people have in their minds is that, oh! she is so calm and polite and too weak for this particular position, Just because she is ~~weak and~~ a woman. This is not at all true and I defend my ~~opin~~ statement because we see many institutions in our surroundings that prove this fact that women are equally strong like the men of our society. Have we not observed women like leading politicians Benazir Bhutto to some being very famous scientists and social workers like Ruth Fao and Afa Karim. Thus, stereotypes are never ~~de~~ justified and ~~defined~~ can be defined as totally facile and rotten thoughts that we develop regarding our fellow human beings on the basis of some negative thoughts and incidents that should not be remembered.

In *weaker responses* for question 4a, the candidates:

- mentioned reasons in support of the prompt but the ideas failed to make an impression due to randomness of ideas, lack of organisation, repetition of ideas and run-on sentences;
- mentioned incomplete answers with serious and persistent errors;
- showed lack of knowledge of grammar: tenses and subject-verb agreement, spelling and word choice.

Example:



Stereotyping is both negative and positive like the people around me who are stereotypes we called them judgemental too. because stereotyping is like you're doing judgement to other people. but the positive is this that they do more research. stereotype have more knowledege that what is happening around and in the world. Stereotyping can help us to figure out the thing around us. The people who are stereotypes are judgemental as they do researches but sometimes they do judgement on people cast, color, religion etc.

There are people around me who are stereotypes. Stereotyping is what to make a group of people on a sample. The one stereotype around me is my friend He do stereotyping like "All the Pakistanis are muslims" Sometime stereotyping is right and sometimes wrong. The stereotyping is done on the basis of group of a people to the whole.

The people who categorized others people or group on the basis of there cast, culture. The people who do this are called stereotypers. The Stereotyping is done by many people. Nowadays stereotyping is a common thing.

Question 4b:

The gender pay gap is the average difference between a man's and a woman's salaries. According to a report by World Economic Forum, despite significant advances in economic participation, opportunity and educational attainment by women in the past few decades, women on average earn less than men while working on same position and performing same tasks.

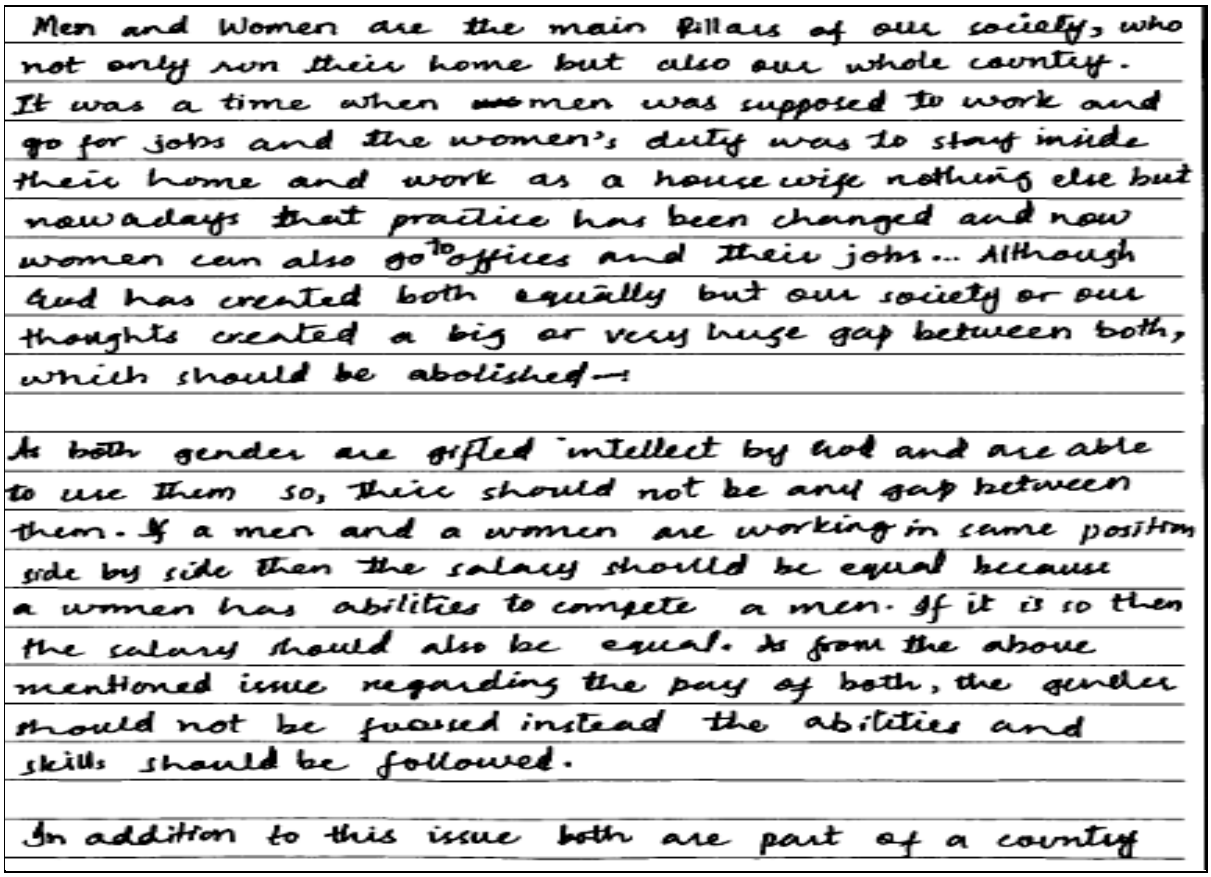
Mention your stance about the issue highlighted above. Should men and women be paid equal salaries when they work side by side performing the same task? Mention FOUR reasons for your stance.

Most candidates chose to attempt this question.

In *better responses* for question 4b, the candidates:

- presented a well-articulated and well-reasoned stance stressing the importance of parity and equality in the pay of both men and women. Socioeconomic necessities, responsibilities of both men and women were quoted as reasons mostly;
- used accurate sentence structure, tenses and subject-verb agreement. Whilst sentence demarcation and issues with agreement or Standard English can be a problem for some, the majority of candidates who scored high marks were able to use varied sentences;
- presented original ideas in a systematic manner.

Example:



Men and Women are the main Pillars of our society, who not only run their home but also our whole country. It was a time when ~~wo~~men was supposed to work and go for jobs and the women's duty was to stay inside their home and work as a house wife nothing else but nowadays that practice has been changed and now women can also go to offices and their jobs... Although God has created both equally but our society or our thoughts created a big or very huge gap between both, which should be abolished—

As both gender are gifted intellect by God and are able to use them so, their should not be any gap between them. If a men and a women are working in same position side by side then the salary should be equal because a women has abilities to compete a men. If it is so then the salary should also be equal. So from the above mentioned issue regarding the pay of both, the gender should not be focused instead the abilities and skills should be followed.

In addition to this issue both are part of a country

If there will be gap between the salaries then the economical conditions will become worseful because nowadays in every field of life women are side by side of men. It was a time when women were not involved or had not participated in nation building services but now that practice got changed. So, the salaries should be given equally.

Moreever, both gender plays vital role in their homes If a women has many children and she is the one to support them then it will be difficult for her to manage every thing like the needs of home, children and etc. Now so, every thing must be keep in view ..

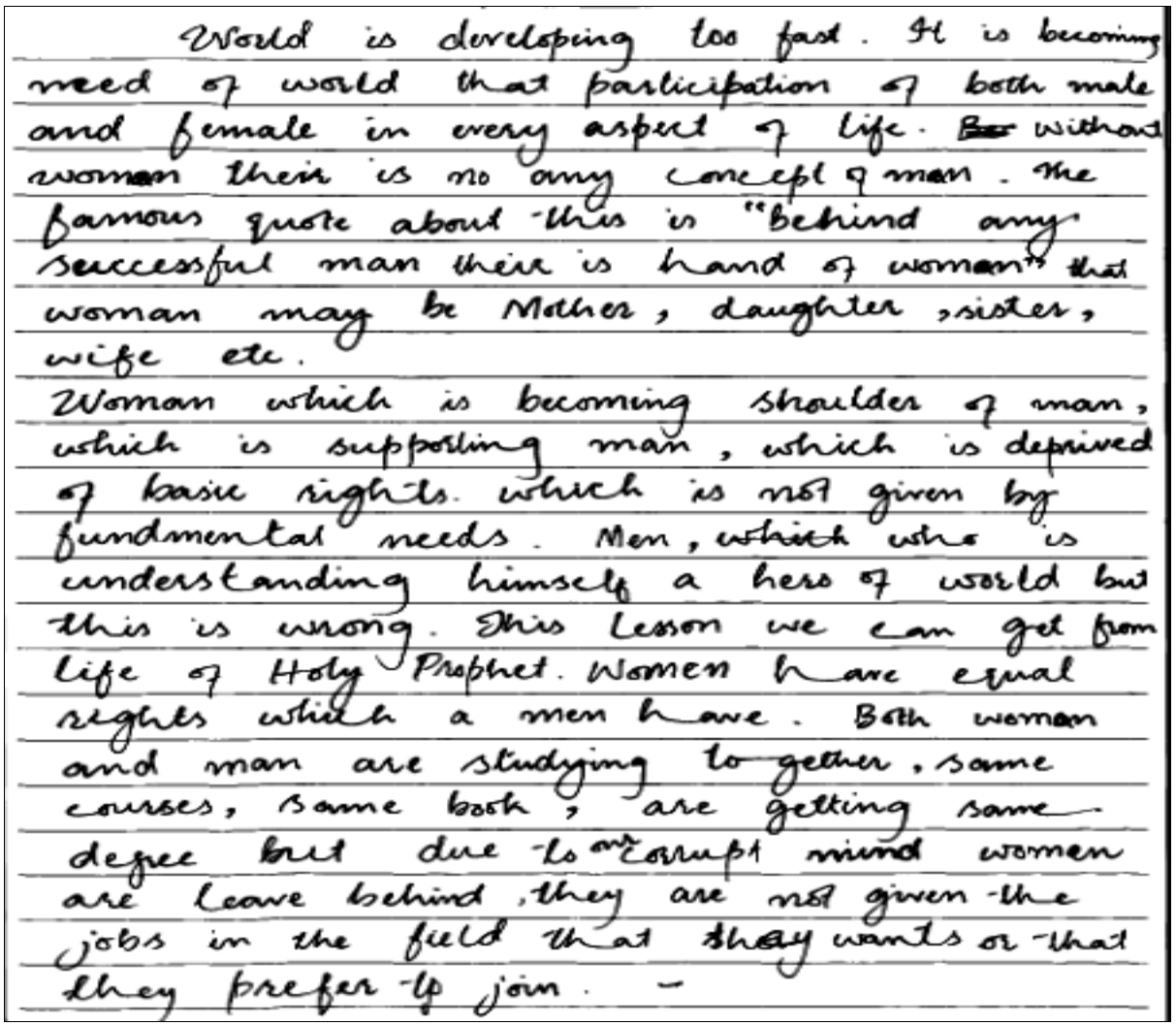
Lastly, the women and men are the wheels of our society. If one will work and the other not then the society will not be able to run and creat a balance and that society will move down and will not be able to develope. So, if the gender discrimination will be stoped and the rights will be given to both then both wheel will create a balance and will be able to move.

Atlast, it should be right of both gender to become equal part of society because as it is said by our founder Quaid-e-Azam that "No nation will touch the glory of height untill or unless your women are side by side with you.". So, the women should be given equall salary as compare to men.

In *weaker responses* for question 4b, the candidates:

- wrote generalised details about the importance of equality but lost focus later on by stressing that men have more responsibility than women. Hence, coherence was not found in ideas;
- showed serious errors of spellings. The issue of technical accuracy is vital for writing and, unfortunately, it was not uncommon to see scripts with technical errors (many of which were very basic - for example, their/there, too/to, where/were, etc.);
- used informal or semi-formal style and incorrect word choice;
- showed lack of knowledge of grammar: tenses, sentence structure and subject-verb agreement.

Example:



World is developing too fast. It is becoming need of world that participation of both male and female in every aspect of life. ~~Bec~~ without women their is no any concept of man. The famous quote about this is "behind any successful man their is hand of woman" that woman may be Mother, daughter, sister, wife etc.

Woman which is becoming shoulder of man, which is supporting man, which is deprived of basic rights. which is not given by fundmental needs. Men, which who is understanding himself a hero of world but this is wrong. This lesson we can get from life of Holy Prophet. Women have equal rights which a men have. Both woman and man are studying together, same courses, same book, are getting same degree but due to our corrupt mind women are leave behind, they are not given the jobs in the field that they wants or that they prefer to join. -

If they are given by job a new problem take birth of salaries. They are appointed on low salaries. where as if a man is appointed on that same job he is given by high salary. This is due to, because she is a women. Women should be given equal rights which a man gets. Cause of doing job of woman may be she would be needy or may be she wants to raise its background or may be she wants to live single. Like a man, women have same stamina of doing any work. If is not justice that the two persons are working job, and completing same tasks are given by difference in salaries.

Every man and woman are given this life once Let them do whether they want to do provide them facilities of that. Taking example of a girl whos dream is from begging to doo own buisness, when she do alot of hardwork and becoming capable of doing work of which she already seams dream. If according to his dream is not fulfiled then she will broke internally.

Question 4c:

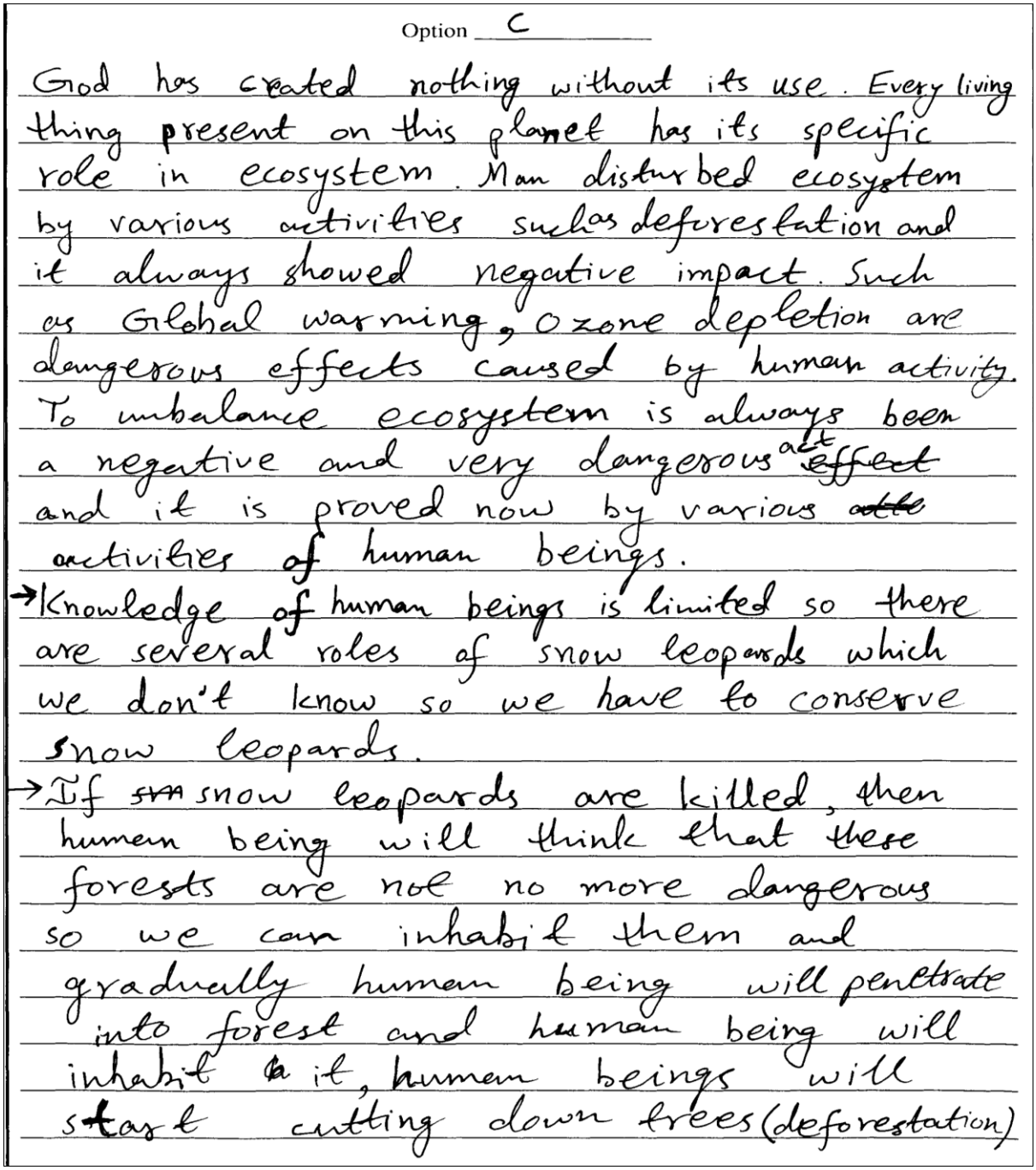
Snow leopard is a rare and beautiful animal which resides in the Northern Areas of Pakistan. Snow leopards frequently kill domestic goats and sheep which are farmer's precious resources. Farmers, hence, often end up killing snow leopards due to which snow leopard's population has diminished significantly. In this way, there is a perpetual human-wildlife conflict. Many Non-government organisations like Project Snow Leopard are working to conserve snow leopard population.

Write an argumentative essay about whether the population of snow leopards should be conserved. Give at least FOUR reasons for your answer.

In *better responses* for question 4c, the candidates:

- mentioned their viewpoint and presented a well-reasoned and balanced argument;
- presented a well-formed conclusion where all main points were summarised or a memorable expression was given;
- organised information in paragraphs and mentioned one idea in each paragraph;
- used grammar: tenses and subject-verb agreement appropriately.

Example:



Option C

God has created nothing without its use. Every living thing present on this planet has its specific role in ecosystem. Man disturbed ecosystem by various activities such as deforestation and it always showed negative impact. Such as Global warming, Ozone depletion are dangerous effects caused by human activity. To unbalance ecosystem is always been a negative and very dangerous act ~~effect~~ and it is proved now by various ~~acti~~ activities of human beings.

→ Knowledge of human beings is limited so there are several roles of snow leopards which we don't know so we have to conserve snow leopards.

→ If ~~sno~~ snow leopards are killed, then humen being will think that these forests are not no more dangerous so we can inhabit them and gradually humen being will penetrate into forest and human being will inhabit in it, human beings will start cutting down trees (deforestation)

and we already effects of deforestation such as floods, global so we should be very careful about that.

→ Presence of a specific specie in a ecosystem ensures the controlled population of other species and snow leopard also ensures the population of other species to be in a certain amount. If snow leopard will become extinct ~~that~~ those species which are controlled by snow leopard's presence will increase in number dramatically eventually disturbing ecosystem and can also cause danger to human habitat because when they will increased in ~~no~~ number too much, a forest will be not enough for them so will start inhabiting human habitat.

→ Extinction of snow leopard will result in deforestation and that will eventually effect tourism industry and this will effect economic condition of a country.

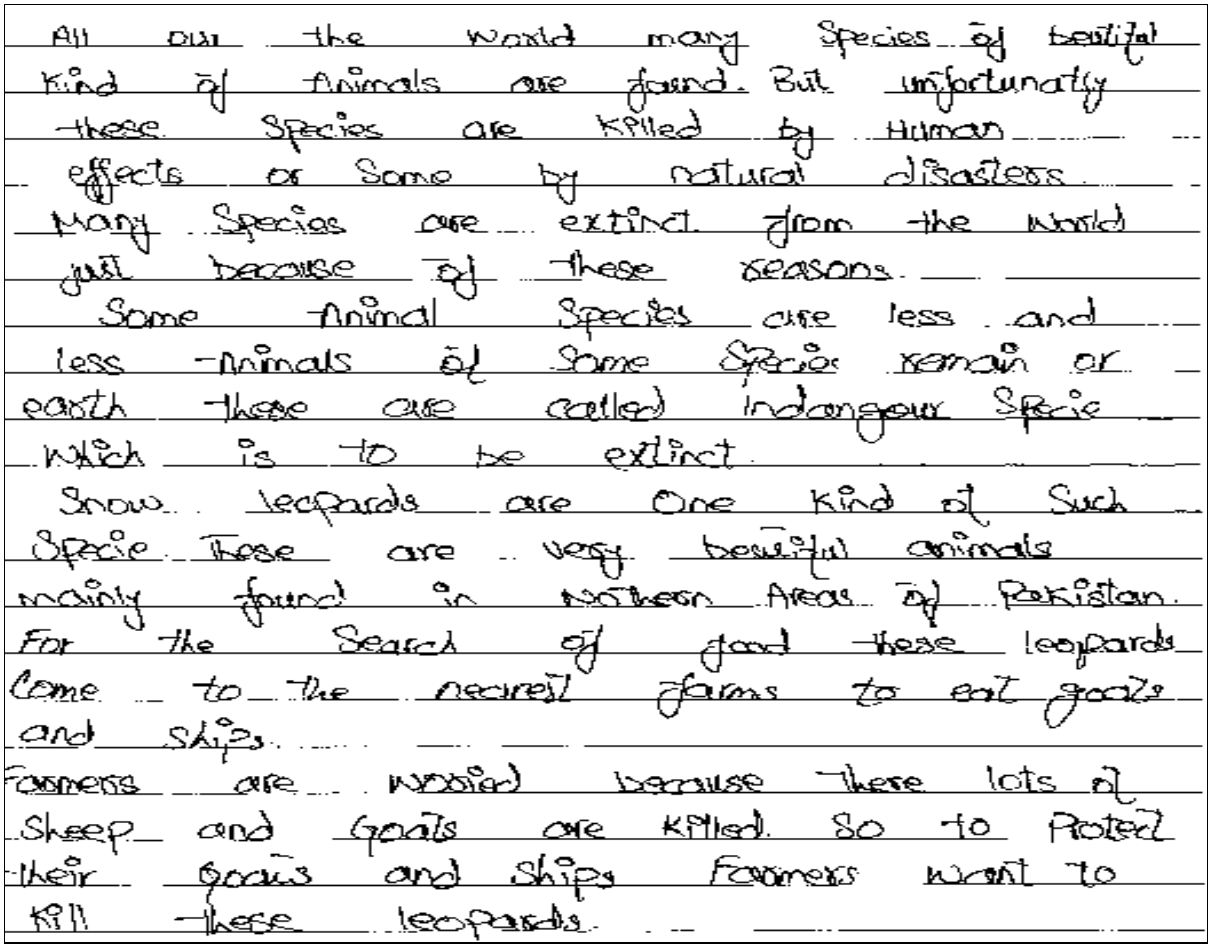
→ Extinction of snow leopard will also edisables us to have a beautiful creature of our God with us.

At the end human will hurt himself by killing these snow leopards. ~~but~~ so instead of it have goats in such areas where there are no snow leopards or human being ~~protect~~ his take several measures to protect his goats instead of killing snow leopards.

In *weaker responses* for question 4c, the candidates

- highlighted the menace farmers faced but failed to give constructive arguments;
- did not communicate their ideas clearly and/ or support the arguments with convincing details
- Showed lack of knowledge of spellings and grammar: tenses and subject-verb agreement.

Example:


All over the world many Species of beutiful kind of Animals are found. But unfortunatly these Species are killed by Human effects or Some by natural disasters many Species are extinct from the World just because of these seasons.

Some Animal Species are less and less Animals of Some Species remain or earth these are called Indangeour Specie which is to be extinct.

Snow leopards are One kind of Such Specie. These are very beutiful animals mainly found in Northern Areas of Pakistan. For the Search of food these leopards come to the nearest farms to eat goats and Ships.

Farmers are worried because there lots of Sheep and Goats are killed. So to Protect their goats and Ships Farmers want to kill these leopards.

Many leopards are killed every year by the hand of fearness.
By this killing leopards become indanjure Specie. less amount of leopards are remain on Earth.
It is very essinsial to Proted this indanjure Specie.
Some of Non-Government Orgnizations are Wosking to Proted these.
I think its better to make more Orgnization and to Save Such a beutiful kind of leopards.

When any of the Animals or Plant Specie extinct from earth it cause effect on all the food chain and food webs of the nature.
Because any other animals also dependon on them for food. Then whole Food chain is disrupted.

Government have to take strong action to Save Such a beutiful creation of God.